HACK-TO-WEEN 2026 · CLOUD SECURITY & THREAT TRIAGE

THE ZOMBIE CREDENTIAL & PHISHING EXORCIST

GHOST PROTOCOL

Find the undead. Break the lure. Prove the fix.

A developer-first threat triage cockpit for exposed secrets and phishing lures.
Serverless on AWS. Built for teams without a 24/7 SOC.



TEAM
NullVoid
Hariprasath · Dhanush S · Jaidev S P · Kalaiyarasan P

TRACK
Cloud Security & Threat Triage
AWS Student Builder Group · IIT Jodhpur

BUILT WITH
Next.js · Tailwind · Python / Node
AWS Lambda · DynamoDB · Cognito

01 / THE HAUNTING

The dead don't stay buried.

Zombie credentials and phishing lures turn small cloud estates into easy targets.

23.8M

new secrets exposed on public GitHub in 2024

+25% year over year

21 sec

median time to click a phishing lure

28 sec to submit credentials

1 key

can pivot from a test repo into production

AWS keys do not expire by default

THREE WAYS THE DEAD WALK

ZOMBIE CREDENTIALS

Keys outlive owners, demos, and environments.

No expiry. No owner. Full access.

ACCESS

PHISHING DOPPELGÄNGERS

A fake MFA reset page steals a real session.

One click. One code. One compromised identity.

IDENTITY

THE TRIAGE GRAVEYARD

Alerts live in five tools. Answers live nowhere.

Small team. 40 tabs. 3 a.m.

PROCESS

The gap isn't detection. It's context — and a safe next step.

Sources: GitGuardian State of Secrets Sprawl 2025; Verizon DBIR 2024; AWS IAM documentation.

02 / THE RITUAL

Exorcise the risk in three moves.

GhostProtocol turns scattered signals into one prioritized, evidence-backed remediation path.

01

HUNT

Find what is still breathing.

- Connect GitHub, AWS, and phishing reports
- Scheduled sweeps + signed webhooks
- Metadata-only scanning — never secret values

→ one normalized signal queue

02

JUDGE

Explain the blast radius.

- Score exposure × privilege × age × reach
- Assign an owner and a plain-English 'why'
- Suppress noise with tenant-safe exceptions

→ one ranked next action

03

EXORCISE

Fix it without breaking prod.

- Dry-run the blast radius first
- Rotate, revoke, or disable with approval
- Verify the old credential is denied; seal evidence

→ one verified outcome

Detection is table stakes.

We close the last mile: safe remediation with proof.

One queue. One owner. One verified outcome.

AWS-native serverless | 10-minute setup | No plaintext secrets | Explainable scoring

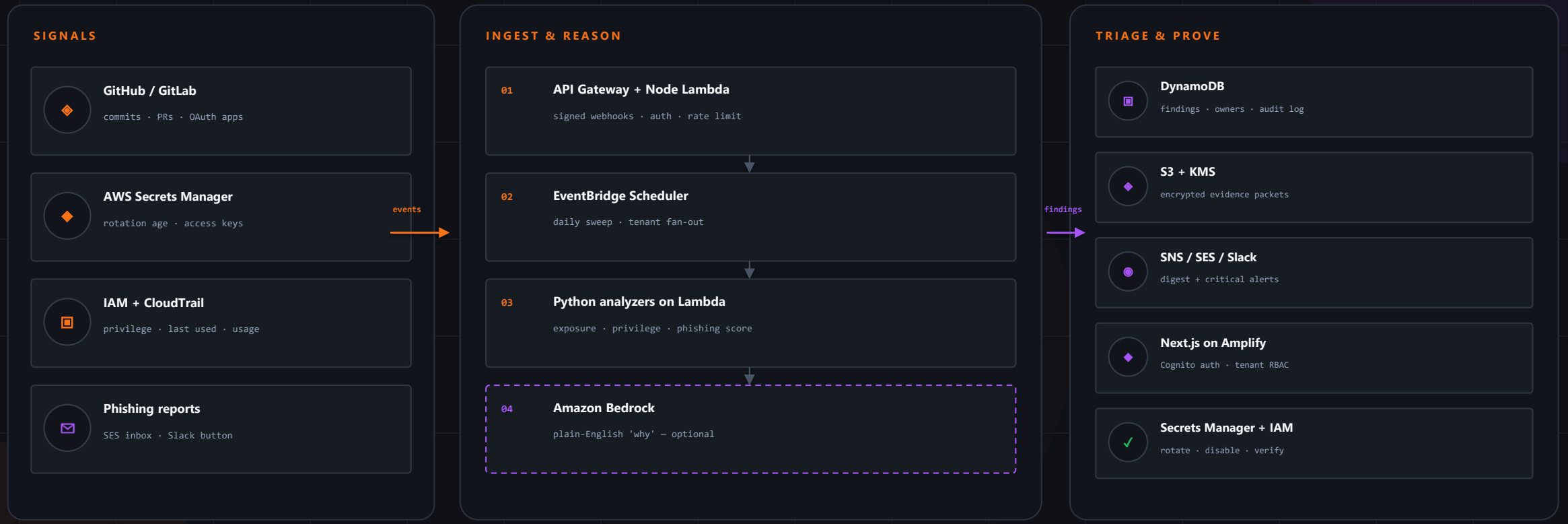
Built for developers, college labs, and small DevOps teams.

03 / THE MACHINE

Serverless by design. Boringly secure by default.

Event-driven AWS pipeline — with a demo-safe fallback that works without a live cloud account.

SOLID = MVP · DASHED = POST-HACKATHON



TRUST BOUNDARY Metadata only · secrets never leave the vault · least-privilege roles · human approval for destructive actions

04 / THE DEMO

From alert to exorcism in under 60 seconds.

A working MVP with deterministic demo data — so the story never depends on conference Wi-Fi.

N

MVP

NECROSCAN

Finds stale IAM keys, leaked .env files, and over-privileged roles.

L

MVP

LURELENS

Scores phishing emails + URLs, extracts IOCs, flags lookalike domains.

T

MVP

TRIAGE CRYPT

One queue ranked by blast radius, owner, and SLA.

E

MVP

EXORCISM RUNBOOK

Dry-run → rotate or revoke → verify → seal evidence.

LIVE WALKTHROUGH · 60 SECONDS

1 — 09:41 — **Four alerts surface**

prod-deploy-key, legacy-admin, MFA lure, stale OAuth.

2 — 09:42 — **Triage the key**

Status: HAUNTING → TRIAGING. Owner assigned.

3 — 09:43 — **Dry-run the fix**

Blast radius: 3 repos, 1 prod role, 2 services.

4 — 09:44 — **Exorcise + verify**

Rotate, deny old key, seal audit evidence.

✓ CONTAINED · old key denied · audit event #GP-1042 sealed

MVP BOUNDARY Discovery + phishing scoring + triage + guided remediation + audit. Live connectors are feature-flagged.

05 / THE SPELLBOOK

Spooky on the surface. Serious underneath.

Halloween is a mental model for risk — not a gimmick that gets in the way of the fix.

CORE PALETTE

Obsidian #0D0F12	Bone #F8FAFC
Pumpkin #F97316	Spectral #A855F7
Ectoplasm #22C55E	Blood #EF4444

TYPE SYSTEM

Bahnschrift	display / headlines
Segoe UI	body / UI copy
Consolas	evidence / IDs

ACCESSIBILITY

- AA contrast; icon + label + color
- Keyboard-first; reduced-motion aware
- Spooky copy, precise actions



SEVERITY TAXONOMY — SPECTER / Critical · POLTERGEIST / High · APPARITION / Medium · WHISPER / Low

06 / THE WARD

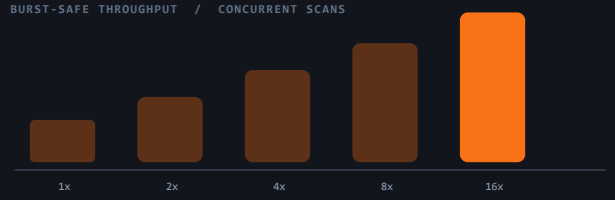
Built to scale. Designed to say no.

Serverless economics, least-privilege boundaries, and a deliberately narrow MVP.

SCALE

- Lambda + SQS absorb scan bursts
- DynamoDB on-demand, tenant-partitioned
- Scale-to-zero; pay per scan, not per seat
- Idempotent jobs, retries, and dead-letter queues

BURST-SAFE THROUGHPUT / CONCURRENT SCANS



Aligned to AWS Well-Architected: reliability + cost.

SECURE

- Metadata only; secret values never rendered
- KMS at rest, TLS in transit
- Cognito auth + tenant RBAC
- Signed audit events; approval gates
- No secrets in logs or LLM prompts

DEFENSE IN DEPTH

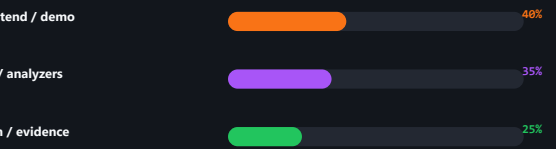
EDGE	signed webhooks
IDENTITY	Cognito + RBAC
DATA	KMS + metadata only
ACTION	approval gate

Security is the product — not a slide.

FEASIBLE

- Hackathon MVP; 3 builders; 5 must-haves
- Demo mode included from day one
- API limits → cache + backoff
- False positives → explainable score + suppression
- Live proof before scale

BUILD SPLIT · HACKATHON WEEKEND



Narrow scope. Credible next step.

DELIBERATELY OUT OF SCOPE

Full CASB · auto-rotation in production · custom SIEM. Narrow now, expandable later.

07 / THE DAWN

The haunting ends here.

Start with one account. Find the first zombie. Prove the fix.

NOW

Hackathon MVP

- 3 connectors + demo mode
- Triage queue + risk score
- Guided rotate / revoke
- Signed audit trail

EXIT · demo runs offline

30 DAYS

Design Partner Pilot

- GitHub App + Slack
- Real AWS onboarding
- PDF evidence packets
- 5 design partners

EXIT · 5 labs onboarding

90 DAYS

Team Workflows

- Approval-based remediation
- Phishing mailbox
- SSO + role templates
- Usage-based billing

EXIT · 3 teams paying

6 MONTHS

Small-Team Security

- Compliance-lite packs
- MSP / lab admin mode
- Threat-intel enrichment
- SOC 2 readiness

EXIT · 10k scans / month

READY TO EXORCISE YOUR CLOUD?

Give us 60 seconds. We'll find your first zombie.

Local MVP demo · 5-minute walkthrough · source available on request

MVP DEMO ›

Runs locally · npm run dev

SOURCE ›

Available on request

Contact · Contact via Unstop team profile

Built at Hack-to-Ween 2026 · AWS Student Builder Group, IIT Jodhpur